

Competitive Analysis

What customers choose. Why they choose it. Where you fit.



The Mistake

"We have no competitors"



The Reality

If the problem exists, customers are already doing something.

Your competitor is not always another company

The clinic wants fewer missed appointments

Appointment Reminder Software

Do nothing

Receptionist calls patients

Clinic Management Software

WhatsApp / SMS

Three types of competition

DIRECT

Solves the same problem in a similar way

INDIRECT

Solves the same problem differently

STATUS QUO

What the customer does today

Start with the customer, not Google

"What do customers do today?"

PART II: UNDERSTAND THE CHOICES



Why do customers choose them?

- **What do they like?**
- **What do they dislike?**
- **Why did they choose it?**
- **Why do they stay?**

Switching is harder than choosing

Better $\neq$ Worth Switching

- Time
- Money
- Risk
- Learning
- Integration

The real question

Why would someone switch to you?

Not:

"Why is our product better?"

PART III: GATHER THE EVIDENCE

Where to look

Website

Product / Demo

Customers

Pricing

Reviews

Job posts / Team

Don't only read what competitors say

THEY SAY

Website
Pitch deck
Marketing

vs.

CUSTOMERS SAY

Reviews
Complaints
Interviews

Read the complaints

Complaints are research

"Too expensive"

"Missing something"

"Poor support"

"Hard to use"

"Too complex"

Build a simple competitive map

	Competitor A	Competitor B	Status Quo
Customer			
Problem			
Price / cost			
Why they stay			
Main weakness			

PART IV: TURN ANALYSIS INTO A DECISION

Avoid the feature trap

Competitor has 12 features



~~**We need 13**~~

More features $\neq$ better position



Look for a gap that matters

A useful gap is...

Important to the customer

Poorly solved today

Something you can actually solve



What will you do differently?

- **Who will we focus on?**
- **What will we solve better?**
- **What will we NOT do?**
- **Why should customers switch?**

Competitive Analysis Map

Competitive Analysis Map

Focus on customer choices, not feature lists. Use evidence, look for patterns, and identify what would make someone switch.

Understand the choices customers have - and decide where you can compete.

1

Customer problem

What problem is the customer trying to solve?

Start with the problem - not with a list of companies.

2

Alternatives today

What can the customer choose instead of you?

Include direct, indirect and status quo - even doing nothing.

3

Why they choose / stay

Why do customers choose these alternatives, and why do they stay?

Look for what they like, dislike and tolerate.

4

Evidence

What evidence can you gather about each alternative?

Website, pricing, product/demo, reviews, customers, job posts/team.

5

Switching barrier

What makes changing difficult for the customer?

Think: time, money, risk, learning and integration.

6

Your opportunity

What gap matters, and what will you do differently?

Who will you focus on? What will you solve better? Why switch to you?

NEXT:

Find 3-5 real alternatives -> gather evidence -> identify the biggest switching barrier -> write one reason to switch.

Competitive Analysis - Worksheet

Misk
Launchpad

Do this next

THIS WEEK

- 1. Find 3–5 alternatives customers use today**
- 2. Read 20 customer reviews/comments**
- 3. Speak to 3 customers about what they use today**
- 4. Identify the biggest switching barrier**
- 5. Write one reason someone should switch to you**

The final takeaway

**Don't study competitors to copy them.
Study them to understand the customer.**



Thank you!

Any questions?